



# MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



## SACRED TEXT

yady\* (evaṃ\* Ceva) pāpa+karmāṇaḥ | paśyeyuḥ karmaṇām\* phalam |  
vameyur\* (uṣṇaṃ\* rudhiraṃ\* Cuṣṇa+rudhiraṃ\*) | marmasv\* abhihatā\* iva || 14.20 |  
X(Cśārīrebhyo\* \*api duḥkhebhyo\* | nāraakebhyo\* manasvinaḥ |  
Xan+āryaiḥ saha saṃvāso\* | mama kṛcchramatamo\* mataḥ | C) Printed as spurious verse  
in a footnote in ed. EHJ.  
ime \*anye karmabhis\* citraiś\* | citta+vispanda+saṃbhavaiḥ |  
tiryag+yonau vicitrāyām | upapannās\* tapasvinaḥ || 14.21 |

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 14, Verse 1

## GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Imagine, if those who commit evil deeds could truly see the consequences of their actions, the pain they inflict reflected back upon themselves, they would recoil in horror, like being struck at their most vulnerable points. This verse from the Buddhacarita paints a stark picture, not necessarily of literal hellfire, but of the immediate and visceral repercussions of negative karma. The text suggests that even the intelligent and mindful, those striving for enlightenment, find the company of the unvirtuous, those detached from noble principles, to be a far greater torment than physical suffering. This highlights the profound impact our environment and relationships have on our spiritual well-being.

The passage then broadens its scope, revealing that various beings, driven by the diverse and often turbulent movements of their minds, are reborn into the animal realm, experiencing a vast array of existences shaped by their past deeds. These verses are not meant to be taken as a literal depiction of punishment but rather as a powerful metaphor for the cyclical nature of suffering and the importance of cultivating ethical conduct. The suffering isn't just some external force; it arises from the very fabric of our actions and intentions.

In modern life, this translates to recognizing the interconnectedness of our actions and their consequences. Every choice you make, every word you speak, every thought you harbor, ripples outwards, affecting not only yourself but also those around you. The “hell” described here isn't a place to fear after death, but a state of being you create through your own actions. It is the anxiety, the stress, the broken relationships, the inner turmoil that arises from living a life out of alignment with compassion and wisdom. Conversely, the “heaven” is the peace, the joy, and the fulfillment that come from cultivating kindness, integrity, and understanding. It is a call to be mindful of your karmic footprint and to strive for a life of purpose and meaning.

## REFLECTION FOR TODAY

*Are you truly aware of the far-reaching effects of your actions, and how can you cultivate more compassionate and ethical behavior in your daily life?*